

Ransomware gang Hunters International says it's shutting down

The ransomware gang known as Hunters International announced on its dark web page Thursday that it is shutting down.

"After careful consideration and in light of recent developments, we have decided to close the Hunters International project," the hackers wrote in a post, without clarifying what specific developments it was referring to. "This decision was not made lightly, and we recognize the impact it has on the organizations we have interacted with."

The hackers also said they are offering free decryption keys "to all companies that have been impacted by our ransomware."

"Our goal is to ensure that you can recover your encrypted data without the burden of paying ransoms," wrote the gang, which asked victims to visit its official site to obtain the decryption keys and to recover the encrypted files.

At the time of writing, there is no such information on the website.

Hunters International has claimed several victims in its two years of existence, including [a U.S. cancer center](#) and the [U.S. Marshals Service](#); however, the law enforcement agency [denied having been hacked](#) by the cybercrime gang.

Project Closure and Free Decryption Software for Affected Companies

We, at Hunters International, wish to inform you of a significant decision regarding our operations. After careful consideration and in light of recent developments, we have decided to close the Hunters International project. This decision was not made lightly, and we recognize the impact it has on the organizations we have interacted with.

As a gesture of goodwill and to assist those affected by our previous activities, we are offering free decryption software to all companies that have been impacted by our ransomware. Our goal is to ensure that you can recover your encrypted data without the burden of paying ransoms.

We understand the challenges that ransomware attacks pose, and we hope that this initiative will help you regain access to your critical information swiftly and efficiently. To access the decryption tools and receive guidance on the recovery process, please visit our official website.

We appreciate your understanding and cooperation during this transition. Our commitment to supporting affected organizations remains our priority as we conclude our operations.

Share on:   

The hunters international post announcing it is shutting down. **Image Credits:**Hunters International (screenshot)

[Several ransomware gangs](#) in the past have released their victims' decryption keys, then shut down, each of them for different reasons. Some shut down only to return under a new name, perhaps in an

attempt to confuse researchers and law enforcement agencies and sometimes to [escape sanctions](#). Others decided to call it quits after obtaining enough funds to retire.

Techcrunch event

Save \$450 on your TechCrunch All Stage pass

Build smarter. Scale faster. Connect deeper. Join visionaries from Precursor Ventures, NEA, Index Ventures, Underscore VC, and beyond for a day packed with strategies, workshops, and meaningful connections.

Save \$450 on your TechCrunch All Stage pass

Build smarter. Scale faster. Connect deeper. Join visionaries from Precursor Ventures, NEA, Index Ventures, Underscore VC, and beyond for a day packed with strategies, workshops, and meaningful connections.

Boston, MA | July 15

[REGISTER NOW](#)

In the case of Hunters International, it's still too early to tell what the gang's motivations are for shutting down, but there were signs as far back as April that point to a rebrand and transition to a group called World Leaks, according to Allan Liska, a threat intelligence analyst at cybersecurity firm Recorded Future.

"I think this is more of a 'cutting of ties' with the old infrastructure," said Liska, who has been tracking ransomware for years. "As far as releasing decryption keys, at this point they aren't likely to make any money from any Hunters' victims who are still out there, so they probably see it as a gesture that doesn't really cost them anything."

World Leaks group uses a new ransomware software and has a new site hosted elsewhere, but the people behind it may be the same, said Liska.

Liska said the reason for the gang going dark may be that "using the same technical infrastructure too long makes you more vulnerable to law enforcement," referring to Hive, a ransomware gang that [was seized and shut down by the FBI](#) in 2023.

"Or, they got wind that law enforcement was closing in and decided to get ahead of them," he said.

Topics

[cybercrime](#), [dark web](#), [hackers](#), [hacking](#), [Hunters International](#), [infosec](#), [ransomware](#), [Security View Bio](#)

July 15, 2025

Boston, MA

From seed to Series C and beyond — founders and VCs of all stages are heading to Boston. Be part of the conversation. Save up to \$425 now and tap into powerful takeaways, peer insights, and game-changing connections.

[Register Now](#)

Most Popular

- [Drive Capital's second act – how the Columbus venture firm found success after a split](#)
 - [Connie Loizos](#)
- [Ask not for whom the Louvre of Bluesky tolls, it tolls for thee](#)

- [Anthony Ha](#)
- [**Google faces EU antitrust complaint over AI Overviews**](#)
 - [Anthony Ha](#)
- [**Ready-made stem cell therapies for pets could be coming**](#)
 - [Connie Loizos](#)
- [**Microsoft is closing its local operations in Pakistan**](#)
 - [Jagmeet Singh](#)
- [**TechCrunch Mobility: The state of EV sales and Rivian secures the next \\$1B from VW**](#)
 - [Kirsten Korosec](#)
- [**EU says it will continue rolling out AI legislation on schedule**](#)
 - [Ram Iyer](#)